Google Play Release Checklist

One-time setup

- [ ] Package name: `com.castlesmashers.game` (can never change after first upload)
- [ ] Upload keystore: create once, back it up in two places, never commit. `keytool -genkeypair -v -keystore castle_upload.keystore -alias upload -keyalg RSA -keysize 2048 -validity 10000`
- [ ] Enrol in Play App Signing (Google holds the app signing key, we sign with the upload key)
- [x] Privacy policy page: `https://stonestorm.pages.dev/privacy/` (Cloudflare Pages, source in `web/`, deploy with `npx wrangler pages deploy web --project-name stonestorm --branch main`). Already used by Settings → Privacy. Paste it in App content → Privacy policy.
- [ ] Store listing contact details: website `https://stonestorm.pages.dev`, email intercoreapp@gmail.com. Keep the policy's developer name (Intercore, India) the same as the Play developer account.
- [ ] `app-ads.txt`: add `web/app-ads.txt` with `google.com, pub-XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX, DIRECT, f08c47fec0942fa0` (real publisher ID) and redeploy
- [ ] AdMob account + app, link to Play listing (`MONETIZATION.md`)
- [ ] In-app products, licence testers, regional prices (`BILLING_SETUP.md`)
- [ ] Firebase project + `google-services.json` (`FIREBASE_SETUP.md`)
- [ ] Personal developer accounts created after Nov 2023: **closed test with ≥12 testers for 14 days** before production access

Each release

Use `tools/release.py` (owner manual: `docs/RELEASE_GUIDE.md`). It does every step below and checks the bundle.

- [ ] Bump `version/code` (+1) and `version/name` in `export_presets.cfg`
- [ ] Release export: Android App Bundle (`.aab`), Gradle build, arm64-v8a + armeabi-v7a
- [ ] Target SDK = current Play requirement (35+ in 2025, 36 set now)
- [ ] Real AdMob IDs, test IDs removed; `debug` flags off
- [ ] Test on device: install, play 3 levels, purchase test (licence tester account), ad test
- [ ] Upload to Internal testing → check pre-launch report → promote

Store listing assets

Asset	Size
App icon	512×512 PNG, 32-bit: `assets/art/brand/play_store_icon_512.png` (built by `tools/make_app_icon.py`)
Feature graphic	1024×500
Phone screenshots	2–8, 16:9 landscape, min 1080 px short side recommended
Tablet screenshots (7" and 10")	optional but improves reach
Short description	≤80 chars
Full description	≤4000 chars

Draft short description: "Fling heroes from your catapult and smash cartoon castles to pieces!"

Forms in Play Console

Content rating (IARC questionnaire: cartoon violence, in-app purchases), target audience 13+, Data safety (answers in `FIREBASE_SETUP.md`), Ads declaration = yes, government app = no. Full checklist: `POLICY_AUDIT.md`.

Studio intro

The INTERCORE STUDIO intro (`assets/intro/`, made by `tools/capture_intro.py` from `art_source/intro/intercore_studio_cinematic_intro.html`) plays on the first launch after install and after every update. **Bump `application/config/version` in project settings for each release**: that change is what makes the intro play again after an update.